



Apple highlighting the important features of Swift at WWDC 14

The WWDC app is the first publicly released app written in Swift. Apple introduced version 1.0 of Swift with the Golden Master of Xcode 6.0 for iOS in September 2014. Apple isn't killing Objective-C, it will stay along with Swift. Many old developers will stick to Objective-C rather than learning an entirely new language to do the same thing that they already know how to. Swift is aimed at attracting newcomers.

Significance

Apple calls it "Objective-C without the C". It is simpler and easier to use than Objective-C. A new programming language takes years to develop a large community and that's no secret. Swift, however, has a different story here. Because of its simplicity and the ever growing ranks of iOS and OS X developers it could achieve mass adoption with an unprecedented speed. Swift is expected to surpass the uptake of Sun Microsystems' Java programming language and Microsoft's C# in the late 1990s and early 2000s.

Swift isn't as attractive as the popular programming languages out there like Ruby, Python and C#. Its only advantage is its simplicity over Objective-C which uses the complex mid-80s style, which is not easy to use as modern programming languages. Swift brings a new tool called "Playground", which lets you see the program as you write enabling you to teach yourself to code.

With Swift you won't need to waste time and keystrokes mentioning the type of each variable; the compiler will infer it from initialization. In addition to this there are some interesting and unusual features like:-